BELLFLOWER UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

16703 South Clark Avenue • Bellflower, California 90706
(562) 866-9011

BOARD OF EDUCATION

President,
Mayra Garza

Vice President,
Brad Crihfield

Clerk,
Maurina Cintron

Member,
Renita Armstrong

Member,
Amie Stewart

Superintendent,
Erin M. Simon, Ed.D.

Bellflower Unified School District
November 2026 School Facilities Bond Measure SM

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Bellflower Unified School District serves students and families in Bellflower and surrounding communities by providing educational programs that prepare students to become responsible, informed, productive citizens who can compete in a diverse world. The District's schools support student learning in reading, math, science, engineering, arts, technology, and career preparation, while providing local students with the classrooms, labs, and school facilities they need to succeed.

What is the Bellflower Unified School District bond measure SM?

The Bellflower Unified School District Bond Measure SM is a local school facilities bond measure scheduled for the November 3, 2026, ballot. If approved by voters, the measure would authorize the District to issue up to **$135 million in general obligation bonds** to repair, modernize, furnish, equip, and improve school facilities throughout the District.

The measure is intended to provide locally controlled funding for specific school facility projects listed in the Bond Project List, including repairs to aging infrastructure, classroom and lab upgrades, student safety improvements, accessibility upgrades, and facilities supporting college and career preparation.

What vote is required for the measure to pass?

The measure requires approval from at least **55% of voters**. A "YES" vote supports the District's bond proposal. A "NO" vote rejects the proposal.

Why did Bellflower Unified School District place the measure on the ballot?

Many Bellflower Unified schools and buildings are more than 70 years old and require upgrades, repairs, and improvements to meet modern educational, safety, accessibility, and building standards. The School District has completed a facilities needs assessment and aligned facility priorities with its educational goals.

BELLFLOWER UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

16703 South Clark Avenue • Bellflower, California 90706
(562) 866-9011

BOARD OF EDUCATION

President,
Mayra Garza

Vice President,
Brad Crihfield

Clerk,
Maurina Cintron

Member,
Renita Armstrong

Member,
Amie Stewart

Superintendent,
Erin M. Simon, Ed.D.

The District completed a districtwide facilities assessment that identified needs related to aging roofs, plumbing, sewer and gas lines, heating, cooling, ventilation, electrical systems, restrooms, classrooms, labs, safety systems, accessibility, technology, and college- and career-preparation facilities.

What is the ballot question voters will be asked to decide?

The adopted ballot measure label states:

"With funds that cannot be taken by the State and spent elsewhere, shall Bellflower Unified School District's measure to repair/replace deteriorating roofs, plumbing, heating, ventilation and electrical systems; upgrade classrooms, labs and career training facilities; and, improve access for students with disabilities be adopted, authorizing $135 million in bonds levying $49 per $100,000 assessed value ($8 million annually) while outstanding, with legal rates, audits, citizen oversight, no funds for administrator salaries and full disclosure of all spending?"

How would bond funds be used?

If approved, bond funds would be used solely for school facility projects listed on the Bond Project List. These projects may include:

- Repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, leaking pipes, outdated plumbing, sewer and gas lines, waterlines, storm drains, heating, cooling, ventilation, and electrical systems
- Upgrading labs, libraries, classrooms, and school facilities
- Improving access for students with disabilities, including ADA upgrades to walkways, parking, restrooms, drinking fountains, playground equipment, classrooms, and facilities
- Updating campus safety and security systems, including fencing, gates, intercoms, cameras, emergency communications, lighting, fire/life safety systems, and door locks
- Renovating restrooms, drinking fountains, water bottle refill stations, water filtration systems, kitchens, cafeterias, eating areas, and serving areas
- Removing or addressing hazardous materials identified before or during construction
- Making health and safety improvements, including seismic reinforcements and repairs to aging or damaged facilities

BELLFLOWER UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT

16703 South Clark Avenue • Bellflower, California 90706
(562) 866-9011

BOARD OF EDUCATION

President,
Mayra Garza

Vice President,
Brad Crihfield

Clerk,
Maurina Cintron

Member,
Renita Armstrong

Member,
Amie Stewart

Superintendent,
Erin M. Simon, Ed.D.

- Modernizing science labs, libraries, classrooms, makerspaces, and facilities for college preparation and career-training programs
- Upgrading instructional technology and technology infrastructure
- Improving classrooms and facilities for music, dance, visual arts, performing arts, science and technology
- Repairing or improving playgrounds, play surfaces, sports fields, gymnasiums, courts, athletic facilities, locker rooms, sidewalks, parking lots, driveways, and walkways
- Modernizing or replacing outdated portable classrooms and improving outdoor learning areas, shade structures, landscaping, and student meeting spaces

Accountability and taxpayer protections are required. Measure SM requires an independent Citizens' Oversight Committee, annual independent financial audits, annual independent performance audits, public reporting to the Board, and full disclosure of bond spending. Bond funds must be spent only on projects listed in the Bond Project List and may not be used for teacher or administrator salaries, pensions, or other school operating expenses.

The measure would authorize up to $135 million in bonds. The estimated average annual tax rate is $45.78 per $100,000 of assessed value, and the highest estimated tax rate is $49 per $100,000 of assessed value. Property taxes are based on assessed value, not market value.

Election Day for the Bellflower Unified School District Bond Measure SM is **Tuesday, November 3, 2026**. A "YES" vote supports the District's bond proposal; a "NO" vote rejects it. All registered voters living within the Bellflower Unified School District (including the communities of Bellflower, Cerritos, and Lakewood) will be eligible to vote on Measure SM. To pass, the measure must receive at least **55% approval** from voters.

Provided for your information only as a public service by Bellflower Unified School District. Fall 2026.